Contribution statement

All three authors contributed equally to every stage of the project. Each stage was divided into three parts, one per author, as listed below; the decisions within each stage were made jointly, and every author reviewed the others' parts.

Stage	**Emmanuel Azubuike** (2698752)	**George Ayensu** (2722188)	**Banele Mkhize** (2663814)
Problem formulation and background	Research question and hypotheses H1–H3	Literature on the archive and these newspapers	Threats to a fair comparison and the response to each (Table 1)
Data preparation and exploration	Loading and cleaning both newspapers	Date- and size-matched sampling; concept word stems	Exploratory classifier and yearly series
Salience analysis (H1)	Rate ratios, bootstrap CIs and matched-set null	Readers' letter detection and letters-versus-rest test	Era drift and the same-editor contrasts
Framing analysis (H2)	Hyper-parameter search for stable embeddings	Profile-shift and neighbour-overlap measures; permutation null	Directional anchor test, robustness checks, detection floor and *umhlaba* senses
Tokenizer fairness (H3)	Tokenizer cost on modern and spelling-altered text	Tokenizer cost on historical text	Tokenizer vocabulary analysis
Responsible NLP and ethics	Limits of interpretation and speaker review	Spelling normalisation and archive labelling	NeurIPS checklist and AI declaration
Writing and reproducibility	Introduction, background and methods	Results, figures and tables	Discussion, supplement, code documentation and reproducibility checks

All authors reviewed and approved the final report and code, and take joint responsibility for them.